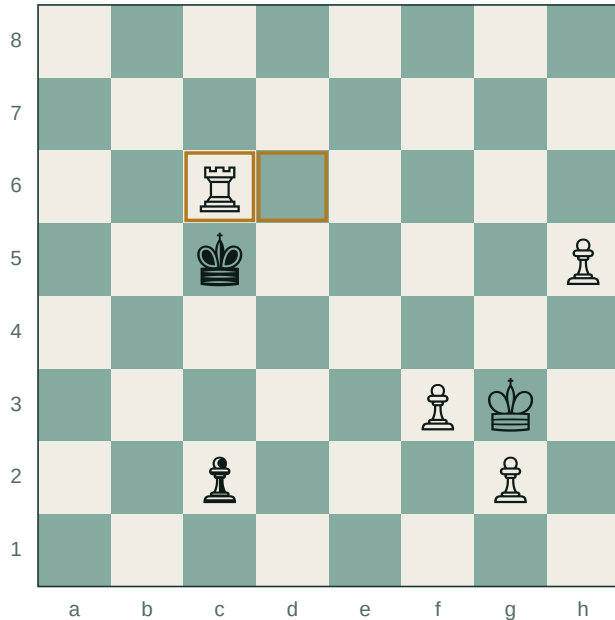


Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 59

Loose-piece tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 59.Rc6+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59...Kxc6 60. h6 c1=Q

59...Kxc6 The king captures the rook on c6. Recorded reply: **60.h6**.

60...c1=Q The pawn moves from c2 to c1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +13. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +13:** the balance goes from -7 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on g3. Geometrically undefended: rook on c6. Check for tactical protection.